RIYADH · DAMMAM · SAUDI ARABIA

16 OCTOBER 2026

Saudi Airports Status

Incident summary and airport deep dives · as of 12:56 AM, Friday 16 October 2026, Riyadh time (UTC+3)

Riyadh airport **Halted** · 64 cancelled today | Dammam airport **Halted** · 49 cancelled

Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday, 5,970 minutes at 1:00 AM; Dammam halted since 11:40 PM, 80 minutes

1

INCIDENT SUMMARY

What is happening now, at both airports and across the Kingdom.

HEADLINE

- **Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday, 5,970 minutes at 1:00 AM; NOTAM A3604/26 keeps it closed until 12:00 AM Sunday 18 Oct**.
- No Riyadh takeoff or landing in the last hour; 64 flights cancelled so far for Friday (15% of scheduled).
- UN Security Council condemned the Houthi escalation and affirmed the Kingdom's right to self-defense (SPA 11:34 PM, Al Ekhbariya 12:05 AM); no new attack, intercept or Civil Defense alert since the 10:37 PM Jizan alert.
- Dammam halted since 11:40 PM, 80 minutes: no takeoff or landing since NE151 to Cairo at 11:40 PM; latest landing XY712 from Taif at 11:18 PM.
- 49 Dammam flights cancelled today.

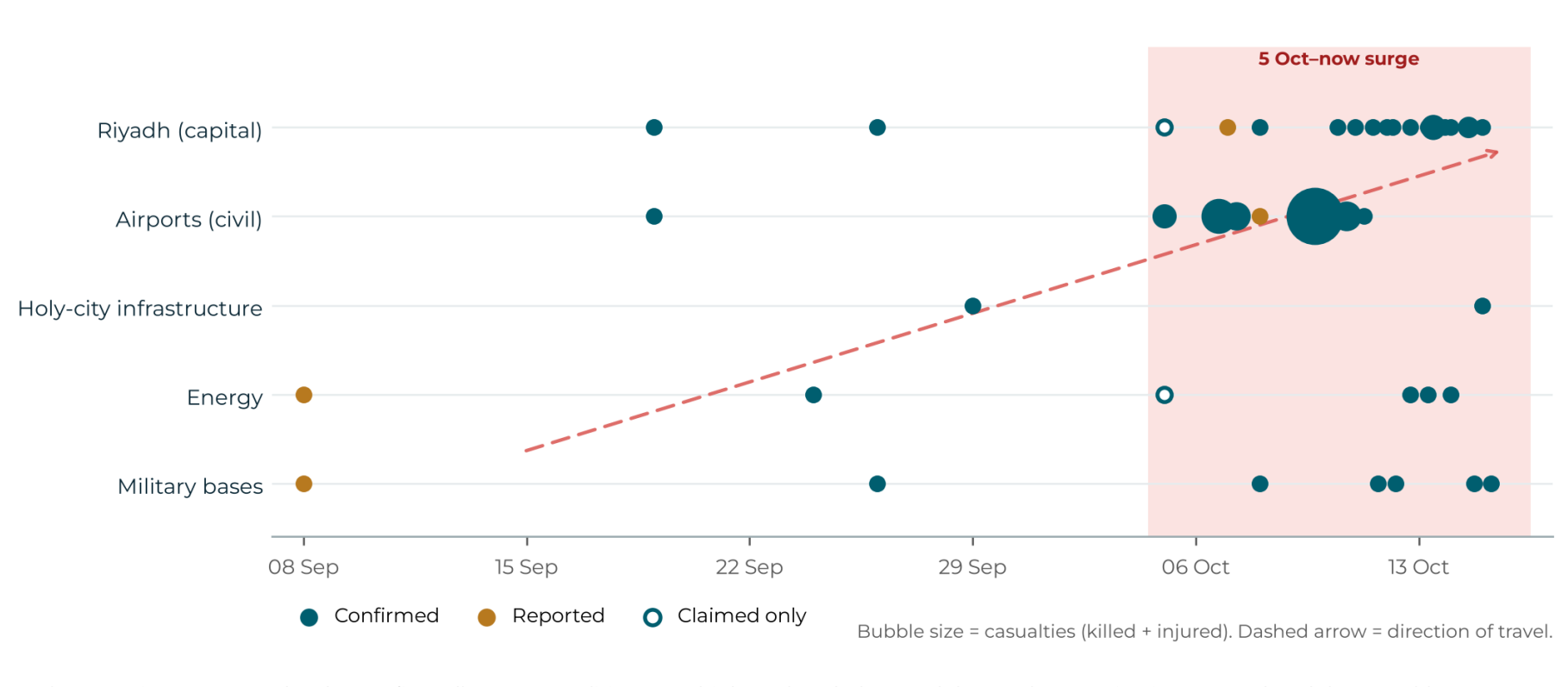
RIYADH AIRPORT		RUH
HALTED		
No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (5967 min).		
64	0/0	2
CANCELLED TODAY	TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H	DIVERTED

DAMMAM AIRPORT		DMM
HALTED		
No takeoff or landing since 11:40 PM (76 min).		
49	0/0	0
CANCELLED TODAY	TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H	DIVERTED

WHAT CHANGED IN THE LAST HOUR

- Riyadh still halted since 9:29 PM Sunday (5,850 min at 11:00 PM). Dammam moving with no open halt: 1 takeoff and 4 landings in the last hour (latest landing NP131 from Cairo 10:43 PM). Civil Defense early-warning alert in Jizan 10:37 PM, all-clear 10:40 PM (Al Ekhbariya, CONFIRMED). No new GACA airport-operations statement this hour.

ESCALATION PATTERN: HOUTHI STRIKES ON KSA BY TARGET TYPE, 8 SEP – 16 OCT



41 sourced events since 8 September (35 confirmed). Latest: Coalition: Houthi drone headed toward the southern region intercepted and destroyed (15 Oct, Coalition spokesman / SPA / Al Ekhbariya; none reported (intercept)). Each event has a source link in strikes.json and on the website. Filled = confirmed officially; amber = reported by credible media; hollow = claimed only (Houthi or unattributed). Events without a source are not plotted.

SO WHAT

The campaign has climbed an escalation ladder: from military targets to economic targets (Aramco, Yanbu), then to symbolic targets (the Madinah power station serving the Prophet's Mosque), and now to civilian aviation and the capital. King Khalid International Airport has been hit or targeted on 19 Sep, 5, 7, 8, 10 and 11 Oct; the 10–11 Oct strikes closed it indefinitely. On the evening of 11 Oct GACA confirmed a further attack on Dammam's King Fahd International Airport. Each rung raises the reputational cost to the Kingdom more than the military cost.

2

ATTACKS, INTERCEPTIONS & ALERTS (KSA-WIDE)

Every attack, interception, Civil Defense alert and all-clear, debris fall and casualty report since 12:00 AM.

Sources: Coalition spokesman, SPA, Civil Defense, Interior and Energy ministries, Al Ekhbariya, Reuters/AP. Riyadh time.

No new attacks, interceptions or alerts since 12:00 AM AST.

Last 24 hours: Interceptions 4, alerts 4, all-clears 4, casualty reports 1.

3

NEWS AND STATEMENTS

Riyadh still halted; Dammam halted since 11:40 PM; UN Security Council affirms Kingdom's right to self-defense

Checked at 12:58 AM: Reuters, AP, AFP, Arab News, SPA, GACA, Flightradar24 on X. Times are publication or post times, Riyadh time.

CONFIRMED **King Khalid International Airport tells travelers to follow official authorities for airspace updates and contact their airline**
King Khalid Intl Airport (@KKIASA) · **11:39 PM** · published 11:39 PM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account, reply to a traveler); checked 11:58 PM

Replying to a traveler, the airport's official account said that for the latest airspace updates people should follow the competent official authorities and contact the airline they booked with. It gave no reopening time.

CONFIRMED **UN Security Council condemns the Houthi escalation against the Kingdom and affirms its right to self-defense**
SPA (@SPAregions) · **11:34 PM** · SPA published 11:34 PM AST Thu 15 Oct; Al Ekhbariya follow-up 12:05 AM Fri 16 Oct (https://x.com/alekhbariyatv/status/2110839596539879878); checked 12:58 AM

SPA reported that UN Security Council members condemned the Houthi attacks on the Kingdom in the strongest terms. Al Ekhbariya added at 12:05 AM that the Council affirmed Saudi Arabia's right to self-defense.

CONFIRMED **Al Ekhbariya tallies Houthi attacks on the Kingdom since March 2016: 1,104 ballistic missiles and 1,135 drones**
Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **11:09 PM** · published 11:09 PM AST Thu 15 Oct (state TV infographic); checked 11:58 PM

A state TV infographic counts Houthi attacks on Saudi Arabia from 26 March 2016 to 15 October 2026 at 1,104 ballistic missiles, 1,135 drones, 118 explosive boats and 278 naval mines.

CONFIRMED **Civil Defense issues early-warning alert for Jizan, then declares the danger over three minutes later**
Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv), relaying Saudi Civil Defense · **10:37 PM** · published 10:37 PM and 10:40 PM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account); checked 10:48 PM

Al Ekhbariya, citing Civil Defense, reported an early-warning alert in Jizan at 10:37 PM and the all-clear at 10:40 PM. No interception, debris or casualties were reported. At 10:41 PM Civil Defense repeated that filming or sharing intercept or impact-site information is a legal liability.

UNVERIFIED **Khaleej Times: more than 4,000 flights cancelled in a week across Saudi Arabia as Riyadh airport stays shut**
Khaleej Times · **7:26 PM** · published 7:26 PM AST Thu 15 Oct; checked 10:52 PM

Khaleej Times reports more than 4,000 flights cancelled in a week as King Khalid International Airport remains closed. The count is the outlet's own and has not been confirmed by GACA.

CONFIRMED **Coalition spokesman releases footage of a drone being intercepted**
SPA (@SPAregions) · **9:53 PM** · published 9:53 PM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account); checked 9:58 PM

SPA posted footage from the coalition spokesman showing a drone interception. The post gives no location or time, so it is not counted as a new interception.

CONFIRMED **Coalition spokesman releases footage of a cruise missile being intercepted and destroyed**
SPA (@SPAregions) · **9:41 PM** · published 9:41 PM AST Thu 15 Oct, first posted 9:26 PM (official account); checked 9:58 PM

SPA posted two clips from the coalition spokesman showing a cruise missile being intercepted and destroyed. Neither post gives a location or time, so it is not counted as a new interception.

CONFIRMED **Coalition says regional parties helped the Houthi militia with advanced technology**
Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **9:37 PM** · published 9:37 PM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account); checked 9:58 PM

Al Ekhbariya, relaying the coalition, said regional parties helped the Houthi militia with advanced technologies. The parties were not named in the post.

CONFIRMED **Kenya's foreign minister calls Saudi deputy foreign minister to condemn Houthi attacks on the Kingdom**
SPA (@SPAregions) · **9:08 PM** · published 9:08 PM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account); checked 9:58 PM

Kenya's foreign minister condemned the Houthi militia's attacks on the Kingdom, civilian sites and vital facilities, and expressed solidarity with Saudi Arabia, SPA said.

CONFIRMED **Coalition publishes video of Houthi attacks on Abha, Najran and Jizan airports shown at today's press conference**
Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox) · **8:53 PM** · published 8:53 PM AST Thu 15 Oct; SPA reposted at 9:00 and 9:01 PM; checked 9:58 PM

The coalition spokesman released video, shown at today's press conference, of earlier Houthi attacks on Abha International, Najran International and King Abdullah International (Jizan) airports. This is footage of past attacks, not a new strike.

CONFIRMED **Coalition spokesman at KKIA-attack press conference: targeting civilian airports is a flagrant violation of international humanitarian law; coalition will keep dismantling Houthi offensive capabilities**
SPA (@SPAregions) / Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox) · **8:09 PM** · SPA published 8:09 PM AST Thu 15 Oct (translated); Coalition posted the conference press release at 7:53 PM (Arabic) and 8:43 PM (English, https://x.com/CJFCSpox/status/2110788783125721325); checked 8:50 PM; SPA English repeated it at 9:05 PM

SPA quoted the Coalition's official spokesman at today's press conference on the King Khalid International Airport attack as saying that targeting civilian airports is a flagrant violation of international humanitarian law and that the coalition will continue dismantling the Houthis' offensive capabilities. The Coalition also posted the conference press release in Arabic (7:53 PM) and English (8:43 PM).

CONFIRMED **Coalition spokesman Maj. Gen. Turki Al-Maliki's "final message" to the Houthi militia: read the coalition statement carefully and between the lines**
Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **8:02 PM** · published 8:02 PM AST Thu 15 Oct (infographic, translated); checked 8:50 PM

Al Ekhbariya posted an infographic quoting Coalition spokesman Maj. Gen. Turki Al-Maliki: "A final message to the terrorist Houthi militia: read the coalition statement carefully and read between the lines." No new operation was announced with it.

CONFIRMED **Al Ekhbariya: Houthi militia fired 16 ballistic missiles and other projectiles at residential neighborhoods in Marib, Yemen**
Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **8:08 PM** · published 8:08 PM AST Thu 15 Oct (breaking, translated); inside Yemen, not a strike on Saudi Arabia; checked 8:50 PM; Marib media office repeated via Al Ekhbariya at 9:15 PM

Al Ekhbariya reported, as breaking news, that the Houthi militia targeted residential neighborhoods in Marib with 16 ballistic missiles and other projectiles. No casualty figures were given in the post.

CONFIRMED **SPA: Coalition: UAV Intercepted, Destroyed in Khamis Mushait.**
SPA (@Spa_Eng) · **7:46 PM** · published 7:46 PM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account); checked 7:56 PM

Coalition: UAV Intercepted, Destroyed in Khamis Mushait. #SPAGOV

CONFIRMED **Coalition: drone launched by the Houthi militia toward the southern region intercepted and destroyed**
Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox) · **7:33 PM** · published 7:33 PM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account); also SPA @SPAregions 7:35 PM, Al Ekhbariya 7:35 PM and SPA English @Spa_Eng 8:19 PM; checked 8:50 PM

The Coalition said its forces intercepted and destroyed a drone launched by the Houthi militia toward the southern region. No casualties were reported with the statement.

CONFIRMED **Yemeni armed forces: more than 1,250 precision targeting operations against Houthi military sites in the past 24 hours (Operation Fajr al-Yemen)**
Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **7:39 PM** · published 7:39 PM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account); checked 7:56 PM

Al Ekhbariya, relaying Yemeni armed forces under Operation Fajr al-Yemen, reported more than 1,250 precision targeting operations in the past 24 hours against Houthi military sites, focusing on forward defenses, fortifications, fire sources, observation posts, command nodes, staging areas and supply lines.

CONFIRMED **Coalition: drone intercepted and destroyed over Khamis Mushait**
Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox) · **6:52 PM** · published 6:52 PM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account, translated); SPA relayed at 6:54 PM; checked 6:55 PM

The Coalition said its forces intercepted and destroyed a drone over the city of Khamis Mushait in the Asir region. No casualties or damage were reported with the statement.

CONFIRMED **Defense Minister Prince Khalid bin Salman and his Greek counterpart discuss deepening defense partnership and condemn Houthi terrorist attacks on the Kingdom**
Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **7:04 PM** · published 7:04 PM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account); checked 7:56 PM

Al Ekhbariya reported that Defense Minister Prince Khalid bin Salman and his Greek counterpart discussed strengthening the defense partnership between the two countries and condemned the terrorist attacks by the Houthi militia on the Kingdom.

CONFIRMED **Civil Defense: early-warning alert in Najran at 5:57 PM, danger cleared at 5:59 PM**
Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **5:59 PM** · published 5:57 PM and 5:59 PM AST Thu 15 Oct (relaying Civil Defense, translated); Civil Defense repeated at 5:57 PM that filming or sharing intercept or impact-site information is a legal liability; checked 6:55 PM

Al Ekhbariya, relaying Saudi Civil Defense, reported an early-warning alert for Najran at 5:57 PM and that the danger had passed in Najran at 5:59 PM. No intercept or casualty report was posted with the alert.

CONFIRMED **Yemen's information minister: Houthis fired 5 missiles at the Maashiq presidential palace in Aden; prime minister and cabinet are safe**
Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **5:52 PM** · published 5:52 PM AST Thu 15 Oct (translated); Al Ekhbariya aired footage of the strike at 6:33 PM; checked 6:55 PM

Yemen's information minister said the Houthi militia targeted the Maashiq presidential palace in Aden with 5 missiles, and that the prime minister and all cabinet members are safe. The attack was in Yemen, not on Saudi territory.

CONFIRMED **Coalition demands the Houthis immediately stop all attacks on civilians and civilian sites, including airports, ports, oil facilities and infrastructure; spokesman's "final message": read the statement "between the lines"**
SPA (@SPAregions) · **5:14 PM** · published 5:14 PM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account, translated); Al Ekhbariya relayed Al-Maliki's "final message" at 5:38 PM; checked 5:51 PM

Coalition spokesman Maj. Gen. Turki Al-Maliki said the Houthis must immediately halt every terrorist operation targeting civilians and civilian objects, naming airports, ports, oil facilities and infrastructure. In what Al Ekhbariya billed as a final message, he told the Houthis to stop their attacks on civilians in the Kingdom and to read the Coalition statement carefully and between the lines.

CONFIRMED **Coalition says its "qualitative operation" answered Houthi attacks on King Khalid airport, other airports, ports, oil sites and Red Sea shipping; 127 mountain stores and many launchers destroyed in recent days**
SPA (@SPAregions) · **5:05 PM** · published 5:01–5:05 PM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account, translated); strike footage on Al Ekhbariya 5:17–5:31 PM; checked 5:51 PM

The Coalition spokesman said Joint Forces Command carried out a qualitative operation in response to Houthi attacks on King Khalid International Airport and other airports, ports, oil facilities and commercial ships in the Red Sea, and that 127 mountain storage sites and several launch platforms were destroyed over the past few days. Al Ekhbariya aired footage it said shows strikes on ballistic-missile launchers, a missile store in Saada and tunnels and stores in Sanaa. The spokesman also presented initial investigation findings on the King Khalid airport attack (5:13 PM).

CONFIRMED **Coalition: 19 killed and 364 injured in Houthi attacks on Saudi airports, including 17 killed and 333 injured at King Khalid airport in Riyadh (20 attacks there since early October) and 2 killed, 28 injured at Abha**
Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **4:44 PM** · published 4:40–4:44 PM AST Thu 15 Oct (Coalition press conference, Arabic, translated); checked 5:00 PM Arab News (4:16 PM) and Al Jazeera report the same 20-attack and 17 killed, 333 injured figures for King Khalid airport (attacks of 7 to 11 Oct).

At a press conference, Coalition spokesman Maj. Gen. Turki Al-Maliki said Houthi attacks on the Kingdom's airports have killed 19 people and injured 364: 17 killed and 333 injured at King Khalid International Airport in Riyadh, which has faced 20 Houthi attacks since the start of October, and 2 killed and 28 injured at Abha airport. He put Houthi attacks on the Kingdom since operations began at 1,104 missiles and 1,135 drones.

CONFIRMED **Coalition says it hit 4 sites financing the Houthi militia in Yemen and is working to dismantle its network and eliminate its experts**
Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **4:40 PM** · published 4:40–4:58 PM AST Thu 15 Oct (Coalition press conference, relayed by Al Ekhbariya and SPA, translated); checked 5:00 PM

Al-Maliki said the coalition targeted 4 sites that finance the Houthi militia, that the militia has built mountain depots concentrated in Sanaa, Saada and Amran from which attacks are launched, and that coalition forces are dismantling this network. He said the coalition is committed to international humanitarian law and took precautions to avoid civilian harm, and demanded the Houthis immediately stop attacks on civilians.

CONFIRMED **Coalition shows video of wreckage from the cruise weapon used on King Khalid International Airport; says targeting civilian airports threatens international aviation**
SPA (@SPAregions) · **4:43 PM** · published 4:43–4:46 PM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account, translated); checked 5:00 PM

SPA, quoting the Coalition spokesman, released video of parts of the cruise missile used in the Houthi attack on King Khalid International Airport, and said targeting civilian airports threatens the safety of international civil aviation and travellers of many nationalities.

CONFIRMED **Japan's foreign minister calls Prince Faisal bin Farhan and strongly condemns repeated Houthi attacks on Saudi airports and civilian facilities**
SPA (@SPAregions) · **4:45 PM** · published 4:45 PM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account, translated); English version on @Spa_Eng at 5:34 PM; checked 5:51 PM

Saudi Foreign Minister Prince Faisal bin Farhan received a call from Japan's foreign minister, who strongly condemned the repeated Houthi terrorist attacks on the Kingdom's airports and civilian facilities.

4

KING KHALID INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · RIYADH

Riyadh airport: halted. No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (5967 min).

64	—	—	0	2
FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY	LAST TAKEOFF	LAST LANDING	TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR	ARRIVALS DIVERTED
26 departures + 38 arrivals, 15% of 413 scheduled.	None on the board.	None on the board.	0 landings in the last hour.	Mostly to Qassim, Jeddah.

***Cancellation basis:** Flightradar24 RUH board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 12:56 AM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 64 at 12:57 AM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today, board count	**26**	**38**	**64**	FR24 boards, local day
Cancelled today, stats panel	**26 (13%)**	**38 (17%)**	**64**	FR24 stats panel
Delayed today	**0 (0%)**	**0 (0%)**	**0**	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	**0 (0%)**	**2 (100%)**	**2**	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	**0 min**	**0 min**	**—**	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	**0 of 12**	**0 of 19**	**0 of 31**	FR24 boards
Diverted today	**—**	**2**	**2**	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	**5**	**5**	**10**	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	**227**	**201**	**428**	FR24 stats panel

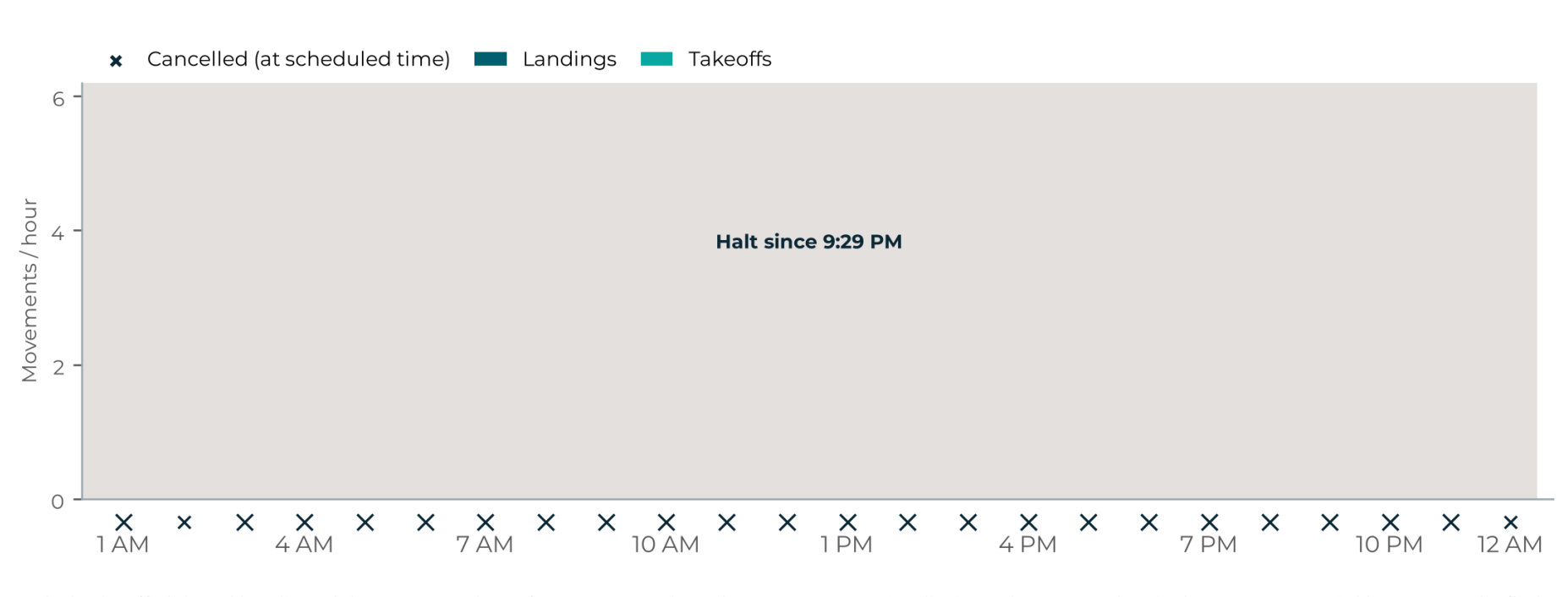
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5

flynas	16
Saudia	14
Qatar Airways	13
flyadeal	9
Royal Jordanian	3

MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5

Madinah	20
Doha	13
Jeddah	5
Cairo	5
Amman	3

TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · RUH



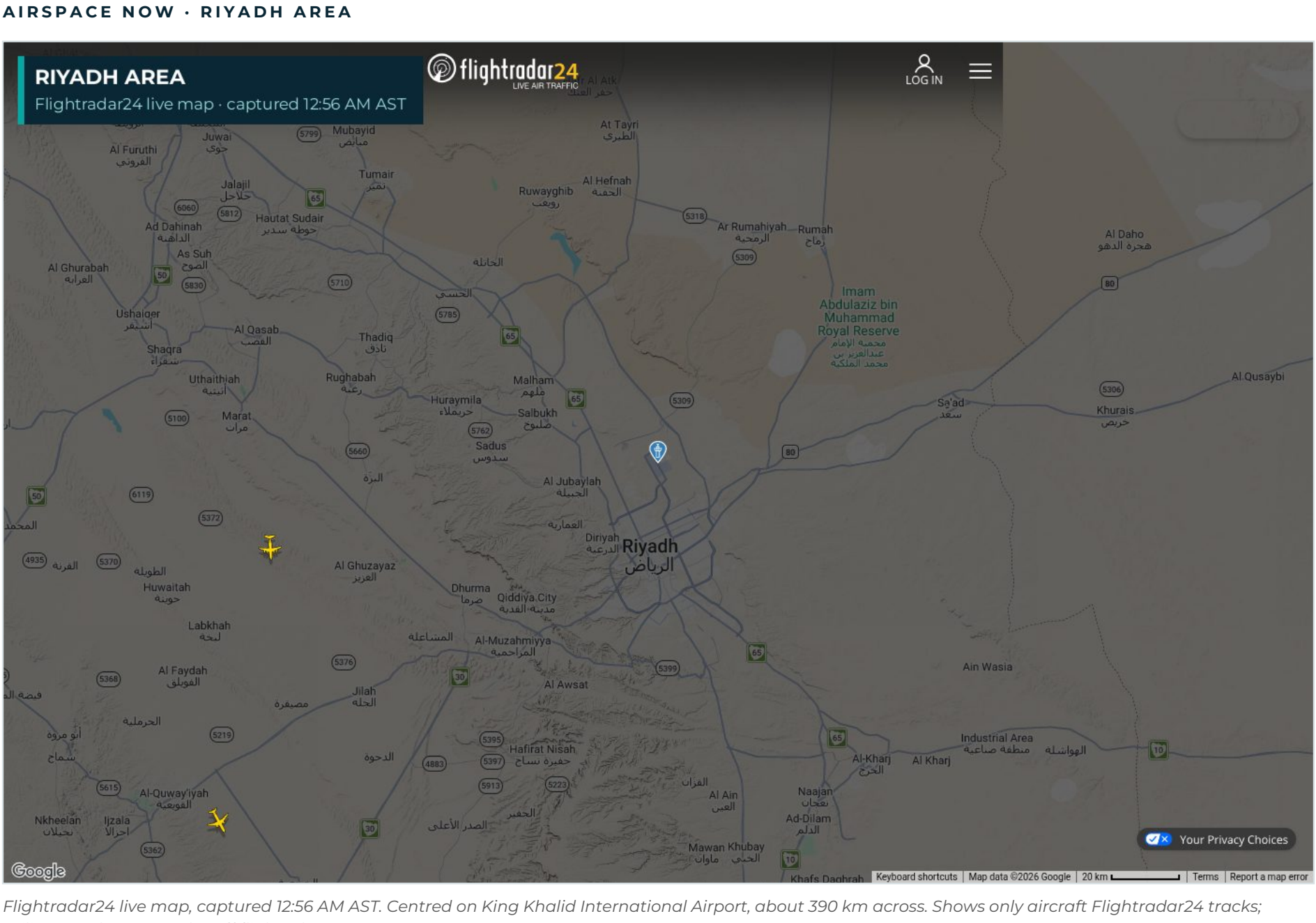
Recorded takeoffs (0) and landings (0) at RUH per hour from 1:00 AM Thursday to 12:56 AM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 RUH departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.

Gray boxes mark halts of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing, worked out from the Flightradar24 board and kept until they roll out of the 24-hour window. Riyadh's open halt since 9:29 PM Sunday covers the whole window, with no Riyadh movement in it. Dammam's halts today ran 2:42–4:54 AM, 5:14–6:59 AM, 8:29–9:31 AM, 9:40–10:51 AM, 11:12 AM–12:07 PM and 1:04–2:42 PM, and 8:58–9:56 PM; traffic has moved since.

HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

OPEN Halt since 9:29 PM	5967 min and counting

AIRSPACE NOW · RIYADH AREA



Flightradar24 live map, captured 12:56 AM AST. Centred on King Khalid International Airport, about 390 km across. Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.

5

KING FAHD INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · DAMMAM

Dammam airport: halted. No takeoff or landing since 11:40 PM (76 min).

49	11:40 PM	11:18 PM	0	0
FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY	LAST TAKEOFF	LAST LANDING	TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR	ARRIVALS DIVERTED
24 departures + 25 arrivals, 21% of 231 scheduled.	NE151 to Cairo, 76 min before 12:56 AM.	XY712 from Taif, 97 min before 12:56 AM.	0 landings in the last hour.	None recorded today.

***Cancellation basis:** Flightradar24 DMM board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 12:56 AM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 49 at 12:57 AM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today, board count	**24**	**25**	**49**	FR24 boards, local day
Cancelled today, stats panel	**24 (21%)**	**25 (21%)**	**49**	FR24 stats panel
Delayed today	**0 (0%)**	**2 (2%)**	**2**	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	**0 (0%)**	**1 (33%)**	**1**	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	**5 min**	**134 min**	**—**	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	**0 of 2**	**0 of 9**	**0 of 11**	FR24 boards
Diverted today	**—**	**0**	**0**	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	**2**	**1**	**3**	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	**50**	**48**	**98**	FR24 stats panel

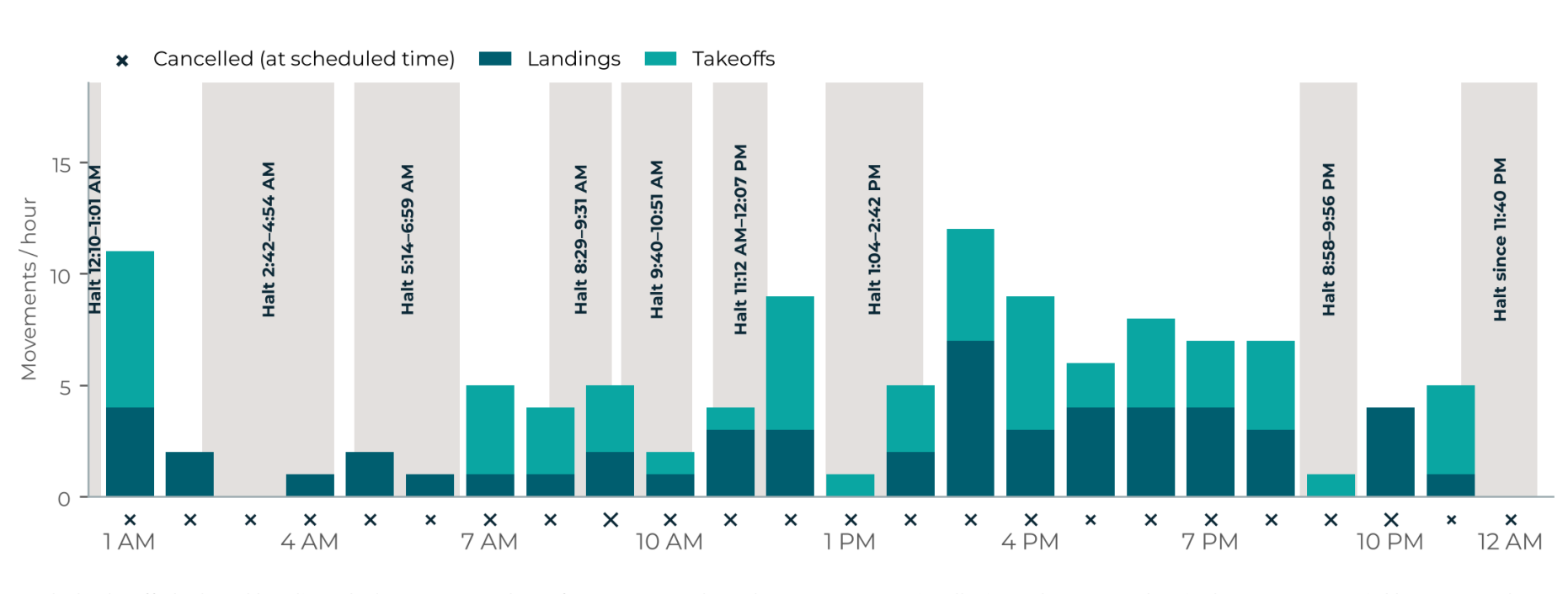
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5

Egyptair	8
Etihad Airways	8
Emirates	6
Qatar Airways	6
Air Arabia	4

MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5

Abu Dhabi	8
Cairo	6
Dubai	6
Doha	6
Jeddah	5

TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · DMM



Recorded takeoffs (58) and landings (53) at DMM per hour from 1:00 AM Thursday to 12:56 AM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 DMM departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.

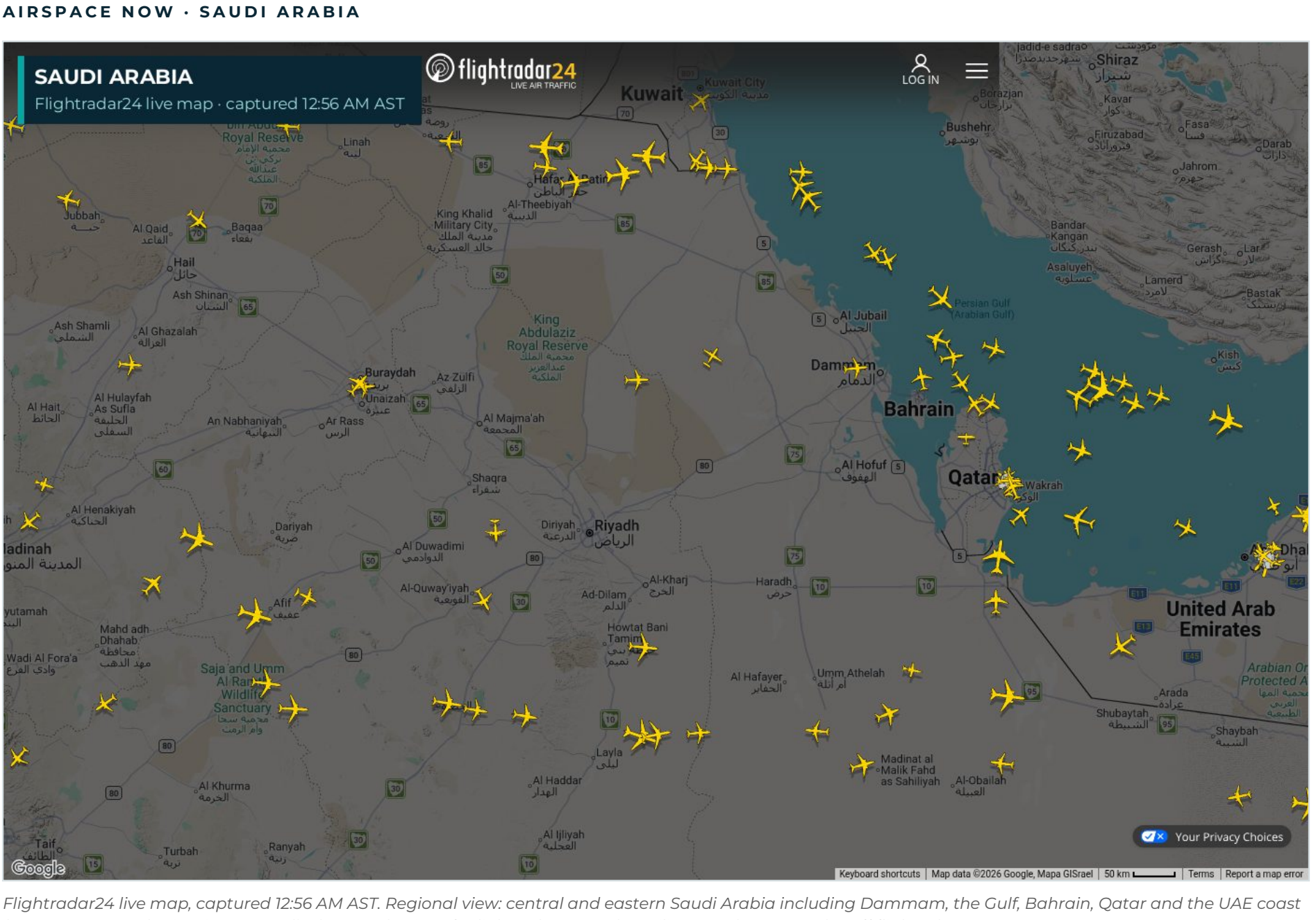
HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

OPEN Halt since 11:40 PM	76 min and counting
Halt 8:58–9:56 PM	58 min
Halt 1:04–2:42 PM	98 min
Halt 11:12 AM–12:07 PM	55 min
Halt 9:40–10:51 AM	71 min

DAMMAM AIRPORT NEWS

No Dammam airport-specific statement or credible report found in this edition's news check (12:58 AM).

AIRSPACE NOW · SAUDI ARABIA



Flightradar24 live map, captured 12:56 AM AST. Regional view: central and eastern Saudi Arabia including Dammam, the Gulf, Bahrain, Qatar and the UAE coast (no Dammam-only view is captured). Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.

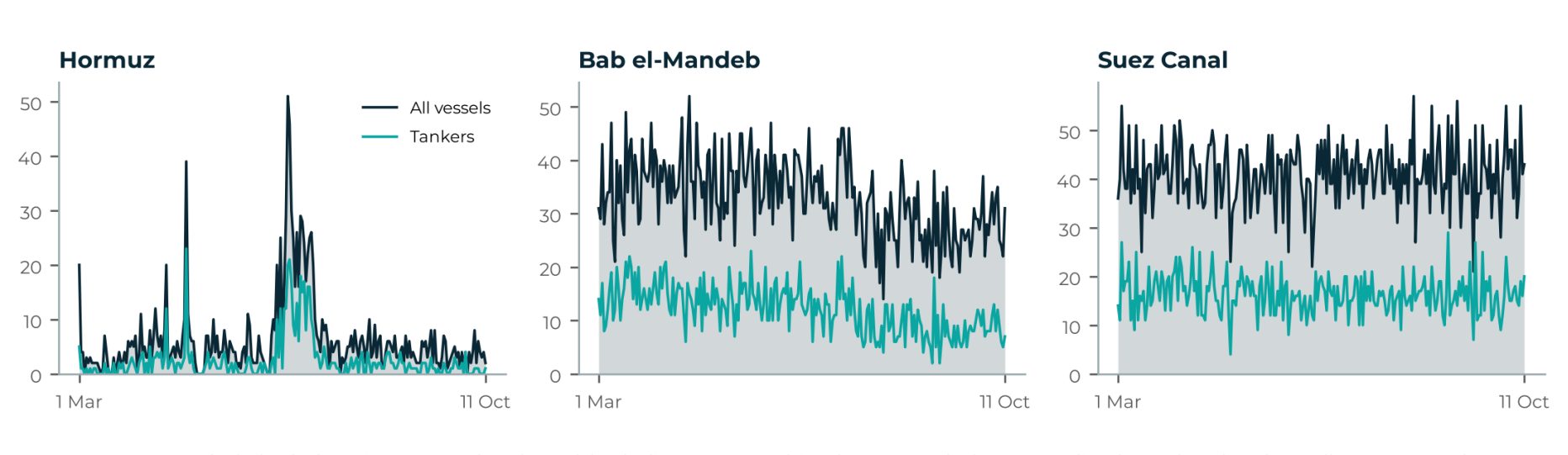
6

ECONOMY

Oil and shipping: Hormuz and Red Sea transits, Saudi crude exports, Brent crude.

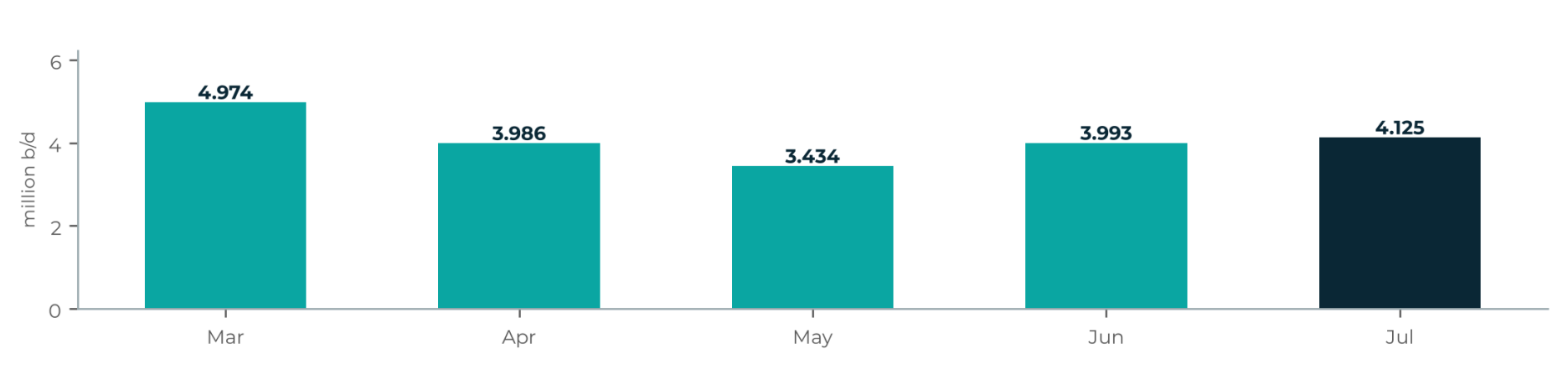
SHIPPING THROUGH HORMUZ AND THE RED SEA (IMF PORTWATCH, DAILY, LAGGED)

CHOKEPOINT	LATEST DAY	ALL VESSELS	TANKERS	OTHER SHIPS	7-DAY AVG (PRIOR 7)
Hormuz	Sun 11 Oct	**2**	1	1	4.1 (2.7)
Bab el-Mandeb	Sun 11 Oct	**31**	7	24	28.3 (29.6)
Suez Canal	Sun 11 Oct	**43**	20	23	41.7 (43.1)



Source: IMF PortWatch daily chokepoint transits (AIS-based, both directions combined; PortWatch does not split inbound and outbound), since 1 March 2026. ***Daily, lagged about 4 to 7 days.*** *Fetched 12:57 AM, Fri 16 Oct AST. Red Sea = Bab el-Mandeb (southern entrance) and Suez Canal (northern exit).*

SAUDI CRUDE OIL EXPORTS, JODI MONTHLY AVERAGE (MILLION BARRELS PER DAY)

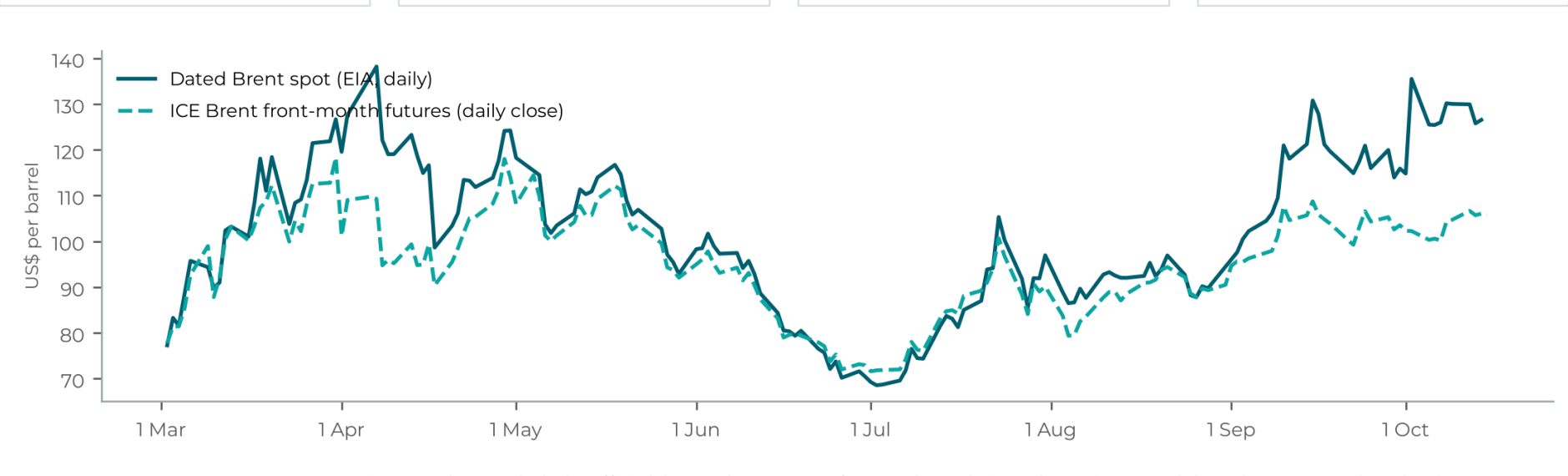


Monthly, lagged about two months. Saudi Arabia does not publish daily export figures and no free daily series exists; JODI is the finest official data. Latest month: July 2026, 4.12 million b/d. Daily cargo-level estimates need a paid tanker-tracking feed (Kpler, Vortexa).

Sources: JODI-Oil via Reuters: Mar (Reuters, 20 May) · Apr (Reuters, 21 Jul (revised from 3.990)) · May (Reuters, 21 Jul) · Jun (Reuters via BOE Report, 20 Aug) · Jul (Reuters via Zawya, 22 Sep).

BRENT CRUDE (US$ PER BARREL)

$105.73	$126.55	+4%	+64%
BRENT FUTURES, LATEST	DATED BRENT SPOT (EIA)	SPOT, 30-DAY CHANGE	SPOT, SINCE 1 MARCH
ICE front-month, 11:59 PM, Thu 15 Oct AST (-0.3% on day). Near real time.	Wed 14 Oct. Daily, published with a lag of several business days.	From $121.25 on Mon 14 Sep.	From $77.24 on Mon 2 Mar; peak $138.21 on Tue 7 Apr.



Sources: US EIA, Europe Brent Spot Price FOB (RBRTE), daily, official, lagged; ICE Brent futures (BZ=F) via Yahoo Finance, delayed quote; weekend values are Friday's close. Physical Dated Brent has traded well above futures since the Gulf disruption, so the two lines differ.

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METHOD AND LIMITS

What the numbers are, and are not.

- Airport figures (last takeoff and landing, counts, cancellations, diversions, charts, halts) come from the Flightradar24 RUH and DMM boards fetched at 12:56 AM, all pages for the local day. Flightradar24 is an unofficial aggregator, not a GACA or airport feed, and actual times can lag by a few minutes.
- Halts are computed per airport from the boards: any gap of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing. Dammam's status level is set automatically (halted if a halt is open; disrupted if 8%+ cancelled, 3+ diversions or a halt in the last 6 hours) unless set by hand.
- Escalation events come from strikes.json; each has a source link. Economy data are lagged: PortWatch by 4 to 7 days, JODI exports by about two months, EIA spot Brent by several business days; the Brent futures quote is near real time.
- Confidence tags: CONFIRMED = official statement made, or directly checked; CORROBORATED = multiple independent reports consistent with board data; UNVERIFIED = single or social reports not confirmed officially. Claims are attributed to their source.

PREPARED	BOARD DATA AS OF	SOURCES	STATUS	HANDLING	NEXT UPDATE
12:56 AM, Fri 16 Oct	12:56 AM	Flightradar24, GACA, AIS/NOTAC, Reuters, AP, AFP, BBC, Sabq, Gulf News, Arab News, SPA	**RUH Halted · DMM Halted**	Open sources · not official	2:00 AM

Sources: Flightradar24, IMF PortWatch, JODI, EIA, Reuters, AP, AFP, SPA · Check your airline · Next update 2:00 AM